Simple Rules, Complex Behavior

Name _____

Work with a partner. Compare answers when you finish each problem.

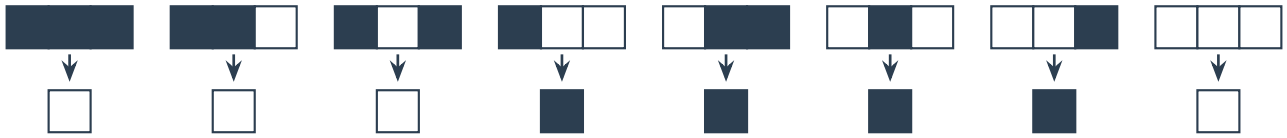
1. The wave. Was anyone in charge of the wave? _____

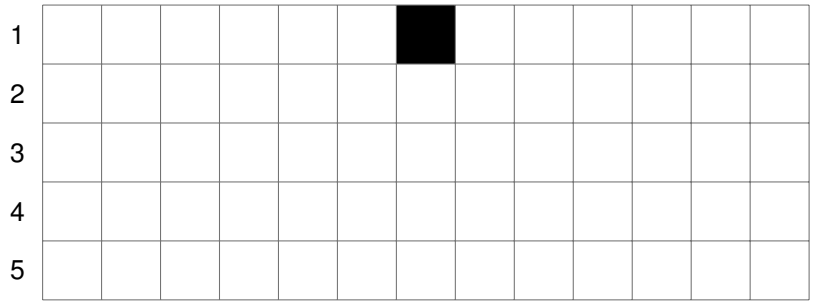
Did the person you watched move down the row? _____ So what moved? _____

When many simple parts make something bigger that nobody planned, it's called _____.

2. Make a few rows. Look at a square and its two neighbors in the row above. Find the same 3 colors on the card. Color the square below. (Outside the grid, everything is white.)

Rule 30: what the middle cell becomes next





Do your rows match the tool's first rows? _____

3. Explore the rules. Draw each rule. Circle what it looks like.

Rule	What does it look like?			
90	never changes	a pattern that repeats	chaos	complex
110	never changes	a pattern that repeats	chaos	complex
4	never changes	a pattern that repeats	chaos	complex
30	never changes	a pattern that repeats	chaos	complex

My own rule. My rule number is _____ It looks like _____

4. Watch the Game of Life.

What did the glider do? _____

Did any single cell move? _____ So what moved? _____

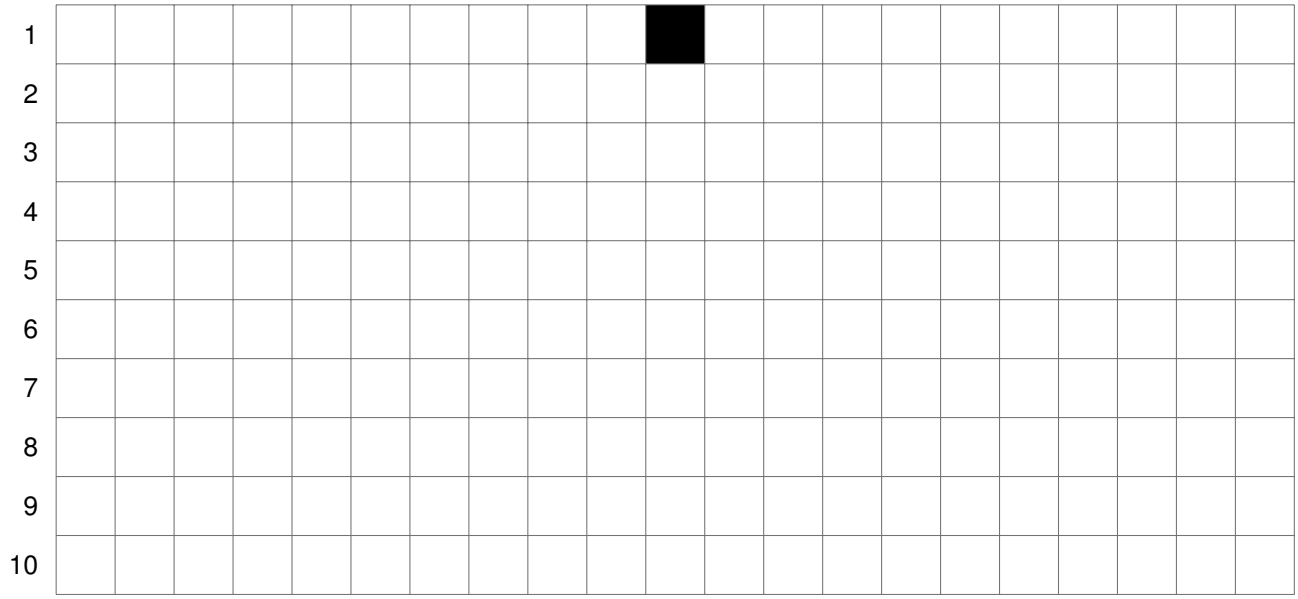
5. Talk about it. Can simple parts make something smart?

I think simple rules **can** / **cannot** make something smart, because _____

_____

_____

Go Further (Day 2). Be Rule 30 as a class. Color each new row the class shows.



Game of Life. A black cell with _____ black neighbors stays black. A white cell with exactly _____ black neighbors turns black.